

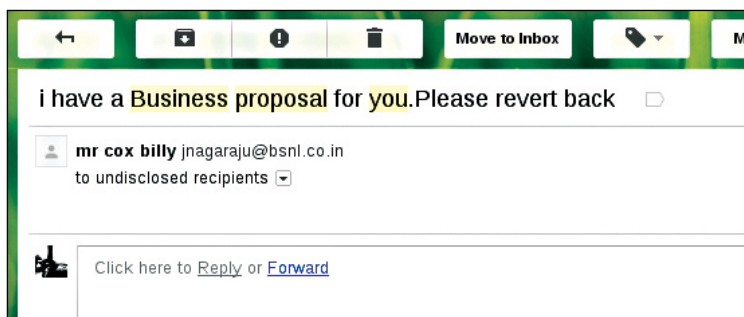
as well. Googling the site name and then opening the site via a result is also a good way to avoid phishing traps but the final defense lies in observing the correct address. Better safe than sorry.

Pharming

Pharming is an attack intended to redirect your website traffic to another, probably bogus website. Sad news: pharming is not easily detectable on your computer. Pharming is usually done by infecting DNS servers which is beyond control and remains undetectable for a large part. The only way pharming could have been done on your computer is by modifying the hosts file. If that file contains bogus entries then some program has tried to perform pharming on your computer. Some site blocking software use the hosts file to map addresses to localhost. Hence, if a web address is being mapped to anything other than 127.0.0.1 (IPv4 loopback address) or ::1 (IPv6 loopback address) in the hosts file, it's indicative of pharming (unless of course, you added an entry in the file).

Spam

Computers have become more intelligent, as have spammers. While in the past, you encountered spam in the form of long email from anonymous people claiming to be heirs of large empires, the trick is now more simple. Spammers now send a very concise email saying "I have a business proposal for you" asking you to revert. Such email is usually sent from unknown email addresses and strange names. Don't get too inquisitive and reply back. It might just lead into a similar situation which would be caused by replying to anonymous heirs of unknown empires.



Make a note of name, email address and content before you reply